319 Empowerment Parent/Participant Handbook

319 Empowerment Center would like to welcome you and your teen to our facility. To ensure that your teen gets the most out of our programs, we would like for you to take a moment, along with your teen, to briefly read over some of our facility and program rules, regulations, and code of conduct. These guidelines are designed to inform parents/guardians and participants of the Teen Center what is expected of them while they are at the Teen Center. **The parent/guardian is responsible to reimburse 319 Empowerment for any damage caused or equipment theft as determined by the Department Director. By signing the Teen Waiver you agree to these terms.**

WHO CAN PARTICIPATE?

319 Empowerment offers drop-in and after school programs at 919 W. 4th St, Waterloo, Iowa 50701. All programs are for Junior High, Middle School and High School students, aged 12-18 (younger if proof can be shown they attend Middle School). The facility is open to both resident and non-resident teens for a nominal fee of $30 per month (scholarships may be available). 319 Empowerment hosts a number of daily activities, cultural programs, monthly special events and periodic field trips.

REGISTRATION

All potential Teen Center participants must fill out the 319 Empowerment Enrollment Form and must have it signed by their parent or legal guardian. Registration Forms are available in the director's office. Teens and their parent/s or legal guardian/s will be required to provide the following information:

1. Current contact information, address, age, school
2. Medical Information, medications taken, allergies
3. Code of Conduct signed
4. Release of Liability signed

All Teens will be required to have their parent or legal guardian sign the Teen Center Enrollment Form and review the Parent Handbook and Code of Conduct prior to their participation in the Teen Center program.

DROP-IN FORMAT

Participation in all Teen Center programs is on a drop-in, voluntary basis. Participants have unlimited in-out privileges. Staff is not responsible for teens when they leave the Teen Center. Please make arrangements with your teen as to when it is appropriate to leave the facility and with whom.

HOURS OF OPERATION

The Teen Center's normal operating hours are:

- **School In Session**
  - Monday-Friday 3:00 pm-7:00 pm
  - Saturday CLOSED
  - Sunday CLOSED
- **School Holidays**
  - Monday-Friday 12:00-7:00 pm
  - Saturday CLOSED
  - Sunday CLOSED

The Teen Center observes City and national holidays. Hours and program schedules are subject to change without notice, although Staff will make every effort to keep you and your teen informed.

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SIGN-IN/OUT PROCEDURES

All teens will be assigned a Teen Center Membership Card. When entering the Teen Center, and before participating in any activities; all participants will be required to scan their membership card in our system to state their attendance. The date and time of participant entry is then recorded.

SIGN IN

All teens MUST sign in upon arrival, so the date and time of the participant entry is then recorded.

SIGN OUT

However, they may go as they please.

PHONE USE

Phone use is made available to teens only to get in contact with their parent or guardian in special circumstances. Participants should always ask a Staff member for permission before using the Teen Center phone. Participants using the phone will be required to indicate their phone call to Staff. The Teen Center phone number is (319) 233-1617.

- No incoming calls to participants unless it's a parent or guardian
- Calls are not exceed 5 minutes unless it is an actual emergency
- Participants are not allowed to answer a ringing phone unless given permission by staff.

Phone use is a privilege and should not be abused. Failure to abide by these rules could lead to termination of phone use by participants, unless absolutely necessary.

RESTROOM USE

- All Restroom Use Rules are posted.
- Participant caught vandalizing or using the restrooms in any manner different from its intended purpose, may lead to suspension, expulsion or removal from the Teen Center.

KITCHEN

- Participants are allowed access to the kitchen and all its amenities with the permission and supervision of a Staff member. **Food and drink are not allowed in computer room.**
- Microwave use is allowed in heating or cooking microwavable foods, in the correct containers
- Participants are responsible for cleaning, storing or disposing of their utensils, plates and cups
- Participants are responsible for their cleanup after Kitchen use

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COMPUTER LAB USE

The Computer Lab is available for Teen Center participants only. Each participant must have a permission slip on file signed by a guardian prior to any computer use.

- Please limit Internet surfing to **30 minutes**
- Priority goes to those participants using computer time for homework
- The downloading of programs or explicit material is **NOT ALLOWED**
- Please save your personal work on your jump drive or cloud storage
- Limit printing to **6 pages daily**
- Close all programs when finished
- **NO** food or drink is allowed in the Computer Lab
- Always ask a staff member for assistance if you are unsure how to do something
- Chairs places inside the Computer Lab are to remain in the Computer Lab
- **DO NOT** change Desktop backgrounds
- Horseplay or any type of physical exertion is **NOT** allowed in the Computer Lab

Failure to abide by these rules may lead to the suspension, permanent suspension or removal from the Teen Center.

FIELD TRIP FORMS

Field Trip Forms are made available to Teen Center participants interested in attending Teen Center sponsored Field Trips. Forms are to be filled in out completely by the parent or guardian of the participating teen.

- Forms must always be received in advance of the field trip date
- Forms must be submitted in person to a Teen Center Staff person

CENTER CODE OF CONDUCT

Participant Responsibilities

- Participants shall be courteous and respectful of adults and fellow participants at all times
- Participants shall obey the rules of the facility.
- Participants shall show respect for center property and the personal property of others.

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Fees, Fines and Assessments

- Fees, Fines, etc. are payable by check, cash, debit, money order, CashApp, and Apple Pay
- Checks should be made payable to the 319 Empowerment Corp
- There will be a fee charged for any returned checks in the amount of the banks charge to 319 Empowerment
- Parents will be fully responsible for losses of and damage to center property by Teen Center Participants

Enforcement of Facility Rules

- Facility rules will be enforced at all times, including, but not limited to 319 Empowerment and city ordinances

Suspension

- There is good cause to suspend participants who exhibit continued and willful disobedience.
- Discipline at the Teen Center will be administered with firmness, fairness and consistency.

If a participant becomes aware of any potentially dangerous and/or illegal situations regarding weapons, drugs alcohol, fights, property damage, theft, etc. or has information regarding such, he/she is requested to report it to a staff member.

PARTICIPANT BEHAVIOR STANDARD

The following is a list of rules to guide participant behavior at the Teen Center. The list is not to be all-inclusive. Parents should promote cooperation and agreement between the home and the Teen Center in an attempt to develop citizenship and high standards of behavior in our youth.

Assault & Battery

It is not permissible to commit assault or battery upon others while at the Teen Center. The Waterloo Police Department or Black Hawk County Sheriff's Office will be notified and all applicable state and federal laws will be enforced.

Assault, Sexual/Battery

It is not permissible to commit sexual assault or battery upon others while at 319 Empowerment Center. The Waterloo Police Department or Black Hawk County Sheriff's Office will be notified and all applicable state and federal laws will be enforced.

Bicycles

Participants may ride bicycles to the 319 Empowerment Center providing that all traffic laws are obeyed. Bicycles must be locked to a bike rack to prevent theft. 319 Empowerment assumes no responsibility for thefts or vandalism.

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Interpersonal Relationships

Appropriate personal relationships are encouraged. The Teen Center policy is one of **"hands off."** Holding hands, arm-in-arm, sitting on lap, hugging and kissing are not appropriate while at the Teen Center. **Sexual harassment will not be tolerated.**

Participants are expected to follow the instruction of 319 Empowerment staff. If a participant disobeys

any 319 Empowerment employee either by action or word, he/she will be considered defiant. Severe defiance will result in suspension.

Dress

Participants at the 319 Empowerment Center have the responsibility to dress and appear in a manner that promotes a safe, neat, clean and wholesome environment. Participants are expected to dress appropriately.

The final authority for what is appropriate, safe, clean, and non-disruptive shall rest with the Teen Center staff. When necessary, the Waterloo Community School District dress code will be implemented to ensure adherence to the rules and regulations mentioned here of.

Gambling

Any form of gambling will not be tolerated.

Gangs

Wearing, carrying or physically displaying gang paraphernalia or making gestures that symbolize gang membership is prohibited and will be confiscated. Engaging in an activity that is gang related is prohibited.

Harassment, Sexual/Hate Crimes

It is illegal to harass others while at 319 Empowerment Center. The Waterloo Police Department or Black Hawk County Sheriff's Office will be notified and all applicable state and federal laws will be enforced.

Hazing

It is against the law for a participant to engage in any hazing activity or threatens to engage in any activity that causes or it likely to cause harm or personal degradation to another participant. Threats or other forms of hazing should be immediately reports to the Teen Center.

Illegal Substance, Drug and Alcohol

Use of or possession of any illegal substance at 319 Empowerment or any center sponsored activity is grounds for immediate suspension.

Loitering (Front of Center/Hallways/Parking Lot)

No loitering is allowed in front of 319 Empowerment, the adjacent hallways or the parking lot.

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Serious Injury, Attempting to Cause

If a participant attempts to cause serious injury to another person, except in the case of self-defense, it will be recommended they be expelled from the Colony Park Community Center. The Waterloo Police Department or Black Hawk County Sheriff's Office will be notified and all applicable state and federal laws will be enforced.

Substances

Permanent felt pens; aerosol spray cans of any type, glue, white out and any other substance that can be misused are not to be brought to 319 Empowerment

Swearing/Profanity

Participants are not to use profanity or vulgar language. Swearing will not be tolerated. Participants will be counseled to be aware of their language. The circumstances will determine if more severe consequences are needed.

Theft

Participants have the responsibility for taking care of their own possessions. Theft is a serious violation of the law and will be dealt with in a swift and often severe manner. Participants are discouraged from bringing large amounts of money or valuable items to the Teen Center. 319 Empowerment is not responsible for any lost or stolen items brought by a participant in the facility.

Any participant who has stolen any equipment from 319 Empowerment will be permanently disqualified from participating in the Teen Center and any Center sponsored activities.

Threats

Threats of personal injury upon other participants are strictly prohibited and will be dealt with in a swift and severe manner.

Skateboards, Roller Skates, Roller Blades, Scooters & Mopeds

Skateboards, roller skates, roller blades, scooters, and mopeds may be riden to 319 Empowerment. However, they may not be used inside the building. 319 Empowerment does not accept responsibility if any of the above listed items are taken/stolen.

Tobacco, Possession of Tobacco and Smoking

If a participant of the Teen Center has in his/her possession, tobacco or cigarettes, cigarette lighter, or matches, this is ground for suspension. Participants who are with other participants who are smoking should make a responsible decision to remove themselves from this area. Otherwise, they, too, may be suspended. The Waterloo Police Department or Black Hawk County Sheriff's Office will be notified when underaged participants are in possession of tobacco products.

Use Cell Phones at the Teen Center

Cell phones must be turned off while inside of the Computer Lab during Homework time. 319 Empowerment is not responsible for any loss of devices.

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Vandalism

Damaging center property or the property of others will not be tolerated. Depending upon the circumstances and severity of the situation, a police report will be made. In any matter regarding such situations however, incidents will be written at all times by the Teen Center staff to keep a record of such behavior. Parents may be liable to pay for damages.

Weapons Brought

There is zero tolerance if a weapon is brought to 319 Empowerment. The participant will be expelled for possession of any firearm, knife, explosive or other dangerous object at 319 Empowerment or at any Center sponsored activity.

Behaviors described above will be addressed by following these procedures:

Depending on the nature and severity of the behavioral offense, staff reserves the right to enforce immediate suspension or appropriate measure(s). Should this approach be unsuccessful, the police may be called to protect the safety and welfare of others.

Violation	First Offense	Second Offense	Third Offense
Assault/Battery Assault/Battery upon any City of Atascadero employee	Parent Notification Police Notification Mandatory Expulsion		
Threats Threats against City of Atascadero personnel	Parent Notification Police Notification Recommended Expulsion	Parent Notification Police Notification Mandatory Expulsion	
Assault/Battery Sexual Assault/Battery	Parent Notification Police Notification Mandatory Expulsion		
Defiance, Disruption, Disrespect	Possible Suspension	Up to 5 day suspension	Up to 10 day suspension or Possible Expulsion
Dress-Wearing clothes that are considered inappropriate by supervisory staff	Change clothes Possible Suspension	Change clothes Up to 5 day suspension	Change clothes Up to 10 day suspension
Gangs-Display of gang related symbols, clothing, etc.	Change clothes or Removal of Gang Related Articles	Same as first offense Possible Suspension	Same as first offense Possible Suspension
Extortion/Robbery	Parent Notification Police Notification Recommended Expulsion	Parent Notification Police Notification Recommended Expulsion	
False Information-Deception/Forgery	Parent Notification Police Notification Recommended Expulsion	Parent Notification Police Notification Recommended Expulsion	
Fighting	Parent Notification Police Notification Up to 30 day suspension	Parent Notification Police Notification Up to 30 day suspension	Parent Notification Police Notification Recommended Expulsion
Harassment, Hate Crimes	Parent Notification Police Notification Up to 30 day suspension	Parent Notification Police Notification Recommended Expulsion	Parent Notification Police Notification Mandatory Expulsion
Harassment, Sexual	Parent Notification Police Notification Up to 30 day suspension	Parent Notification Police Notification Recommended Expulsion	Parent Notification Police Notification Mandatory Expulsion
Controlled Substance-Possession/Under the Influence of	Parent Notification Police Notification Up to 10 day suspension	Parent Notification Police Notification Mandatory Expulsion	
Controlled Substance-Sale of	Parent Notification Police Notification Recommended Expulsion	Parent Notification Police Notification Mandatory Expulsion	
Drug Paraphernalia, Possession/Sale	Parent Notification Police Notification Mandatory Expulsion		
Loitering	Possible Suspension	Up to 10 day suspension	Up to 20 day suspension Police Notification Possible Expulsion
Serious Injury, Attempting to Cause	Parent Notification Police Notification Recommended Expulsion	Parent Notification Police Notification Mandatory Expulsion	
Serious Injury, Caused	Parent Notification Police Notification Recommended Expulsion	Parent Notification Police Notification Mandatory Expulsion	
Swearing-Profanity & Vulgarity	Warning Given Possible Suspension	Up to 5 day suspension	Up to 10 day suspension Possible Expulsion
Theft	Parent Restitution Police Notification Up to 10 day suspension	Parent Restitution Police Notification Recommended Expulsion	Parent Restitution Police Notification Mandatory Expulsion
Tobacco Use/Possession	Police Notification Possible Suspension	Police Notification Up to 5 day Suspension	Police Notification Up to 10 day Suspension
Vandalism or Property Destruction	Parent Restitution Police Notification Possible Suspension	Parent Restitution Police Notification Recommended Expulsion	Parent Restitution Police Notification Mandatory Expulsion
Dangerous Weapons-Possess, Sell or Furnish a knife, explosive or dangerous object	Parent Notification Police Notification Up to 10 day suspension	Parent Notification Police Notification Recommended Expulsion	Parent Notification Police Notification Mandatory Expulsion
Dangerous Weapons-Possess, Sell or Furnish of a Firearm	Parent Notification Police Notification Mandatory Expulsion		
Dangerous Weapons-Brandishing a Knife	Parent Notification Police Notification Mandatory Expulsion		